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# METEORIC

**ROYAL ENFIELD'S NEWEST CRUISER PUTS A FRESH SPIN ON ITS NEW GENERATION 650CC TWIN-CYLINDER MOTOR THAT DEBUTED ON THE INTERCEPTOR AND THE CONTINENTAL GT**

**BY DIPAYAN DUTTA**

The Super Meteor 650, a motorcycle whose low-slung silhouette instantly sets the tone for how authentic this 650 is going to be. All of it starts under the skin, with an all-new bespoke chassis built in conjunction with Harris Performance in the UK, that for now will only fit the Super Meteor 650.

In the flesh, the finishing bits make it instantly feel like the brand's flagship. Be it the brushed aluminium finish on the button cubes, the premium instruments console or even the fact that this is the first Royal Enfield to get an LED headlamp. The indicators and the rounded tail lamp are still conventional but keeping in mind the aggressive price point, it's an almost excusable offence. Another thing that stands out to me is how much Royal Enfield has worked to make the 650cc twin look good in its new home. While the engine remains mostly the same, the casings have been changed to make it appear beefier and better fill out the bay.

From the moment you thumb the starter and fire up the 650cc twin, you are going to notice that while the note is familiar, a lot has changed. The tune, out of the new exhaust system, is raspier and begins to lean into the cruiser ride experience right before you get off the line. The motor itself has been re-mapped, although the peak figures haven't changed, meaning you get 47bhp and 52.3Nm of peak torque. What has changed is the way the engine develops that power. There is a lot more grunt in the lower revs now, which seems to taper off as you get to the upper echelons of the rev band. But here's the part that matters: at 120kmph, the motor is at ease, and there's a low reassuring thump from the twin as it relaxes into the pace, with almost no vibrations.

**Engine**
**649cc, Parallel twin cyl, oil-cooled**
**Power**
**47bhp@7,250rpm**
**Max torque**
**52.3Nm@5,650rpm**

The rider's triangle is feet forward, chest open and back relaxed, which is exactly what you want from a cruiser motorcycle. You get 19-inch tyres up front, which are paired with a 16-inch wheel at the back. What is very different though are the upside 43mm Showas that now suspend the front. The twin-rear springs that are adjustable for five steps of preload add to the cruiser's authenticity. Although they are set stiff in their stock form, they are pretty uncomfortable on bad roads. The Super Meteor handles most curves with grace and actually seems to be very responsive to steering inputs despite the lazy rake and 1,500mm wheelbase.

For the version you see on these pages—the Astral trim with an Interstellar colourway option—prices start at Rs 3.63 lakh (ex-showroom), whereas the base version with the single-tone colours can be had for as low as Rs 3.48 lakh. Although, if you ask me, I'd say: Spend the extra Rs 30,000 to buy the fully kitted-out version of the Super Meteor 650 and really have a cruiser that is perfect right out of the box. ■